

ALISSA MARIE DOUCET

University of Chicago
Committee on Evolutionary Biology
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EDUCATION

2024-	PhD Student, Committee on Evolutionary Biology University of Chicago, Chicago, IL, USA Field Museum of Natural History, Chicago, IL, USA Advisor: Dr. Bruno de Medeiros, PhD
2024	MS, Plant Biology and Conservation, <i>3.95/4.00 GPA</i> Northwestern University Chicago Botanic Garden
2018	MA, Counseling, <i>3.9/4.0 GPA</i> Northeastern Illinois University
2015	BA, Psychology, <i>Cum Laude</i> Northeastern Illinois University
2013	AA, Associate in Arts, <i>Academic Honors</i> College of Lake County

RESEARCH STATEMENT

I am a PhD student in the Committee on Evolutionary Biology at the University of Chicago and the Field Museum of Natural History. I study the evolution of nocturnal insects under global change, with a special interest in flower-visiting Lepidoptera. I am particularly interested in changes in phenology, geographic range, and morphology driven by climate change. I integrate fieldwork, museum collections, environmental DNA (eDNA), automated camera traps, occurrence records, and deep learning to track these changes across space and time. I previously earned my master's degree from Northwestern University, where I studied the population genetics and reproductive ecology of hawkmoth-pollinated plants.

PUBLICATIONS

(Preprint) Godtfredsen, E. B., P. CaraDonna, A. J. Foxx, J. A. Bain, B. J. Connolly, K. M. Dawdy, **A. M. Doucet**, J. L. Fitzgerald, G. E. Kirschke, J. E. Ogilvie, C. C. Rigby, J. P. Scholl, D. J. Sandacz, S. Rosa, A. C. Zink, and A. M. Iler. **(2025)**. Meta-analyses reveal no clear demographic consequences of phenological change across taxa. bioRxiv 2025.10.29.685396.

Doucet, A.M., Andika, I.P., & Hernandez, J. **(2025)**. "Digest: Behavioral plasticity under nutritional stress in nursery web spiders ensures equal reproductive success." qpaf149.

Lynch, L., Kangas, M., Ballut, N., **Doucet, A.M.**, Schoenecker, K., Johnson, P., Gharehaghaji, M., & Minor, E. **(2021)**. Changes in land use and land cover along an urban-rural gradient influence floral resource availability. Current Landscape Ecology Reports.
<https://doi.org/10.1007/s40823-021-00064-1>

RELEVANT SKILLS

Field	Air and flower environmental DNA (eDNA) collection and filtering, pollinator observations, nocturnal automated camera traps (build and processing), diurnal manual camera traps, pollen collection (bee and flower), floral nectar collection and refractometry, insect monitoring and collection, experimental plantings, leaf tissue and fruit collection, floral morphology measurements, vegetation surveys, herbivory surveys, plant voucher collection, iNaturalist
Lab	DNA extractions and quantification, PCR, ddRADSeq library preparation including magnetic beads and blue pippin, insect pinning and spreading, Stacks bioinformatic pipeline, fruit and seed measurements, seed plating, germination trials, seed viability using x-ray, pollen macronutrient analyses (protein, lipid, and carbohydrate), RStudio, meta-analysis, literature review, undergraduate mentorship

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2024	Butterfly Conservation Intern. Baltimore Checkerspot Restoration Project. Advisor: Doug Taron & Allen Lawrence, Peggy Notebaert Nature Museum
2023	Pollinator Conservation Coordinator. Using environmental DNA (eDNA) as a tool for pollinator conservation. Advisor: Aster Hasle, Field Museum

- 2023-2025 Co-Author & Contributor. Computational analysis of wing venation and cell domain patterns in the Grasshopper *Arphia conspersa*.
Advisor: Bruno de Medeiros, PhD, Field Museum
- 2021-2024 Master's Student. How multi-scale spatial distribution impacts genetic diversity and seed viability of an endangered desert plant, *Amsonia tharpii*.
Advisor: Krissa Skogen, PhD, Northwestern University
- 2022-2025 Co-Author & Contributor. The effects of phenological shifts on demographic vital rates: global meta-analysis shows consequences of climate change across taxa.
Advisors: Elsa Godtfredsen, PhD Candidate, Northwestern University; Amy Iler, PhD, Chicago Botanic Garden
- 2021-2023 Research Assistant. Harris Family Foundation Plant Genetics Laboratory, Chicago Botanic Garden
Advisors: Krissa Skogen & Jeremie Fant, PhD. Chicago Botanic Garden
DNA extractions · Qubit · Germination Trials · Greenhouse Experiments
- 2020 Research Intern. Cultural Immersion in Monarchs & Milkweeds Advancing Science Education. (CIM2AS)
Advisor: Mary Ashley, PhD. University of Illinois at Chicago
- 2020-2021 Co-Author & Contributor. Changes in land use and land cover along an urban-rural gradient influence floral resource availability.
Advisor: Emily Minor, PhD. University of Illinois at Chicago
- 2019-2020 Research Coordinator. Stress, Pregnancy and Health- Kids study: How stress and inflammation during pregnancy affect the development of children after birth via epigenetic changes.
Principal Investigators: Matthew Pellerite, MD, NorthShore University HealthSystem; Adriana Weisleder, PhD. Northwestern University
- 2019-2020 Research Assistant. Stress Pregnancy and Health- Dads Study - How the health and life stress of biological fathers at conception affects the development of their children after birth. | Be Well Study - Understanding the clinical needs of underserved Type II Diabetes patients in communities in the Lake County area and providing necessary care.
Principal Investigator: Madeleine Shalowitz, MD. NorthShore University HealthSystem
- 2019-2020 Research Assistant. Experiences of Childhood Adversity and Posttraumatic Adjustment in Military Veterans.
Principal Investigator: Shede Tavakoli, PhD, Northeastern Illinois University

ACADEMIC TALKS

2023. Doucet, A.M. Pollinator surveys using environmental DNA (eDNA) and camera traps. Field Museum, Keller Science Action Center, Chicago, IL

2021. Doucet, A.M., Lynch, L., Kangas, M., Ballut, N., Schoenecker, K., Johnson, P., Gharehaghaji, M., & Minor, E. Changes in Land Use and Land Cover Along an Urban-Rural Gradient Influence Floral Resource Availability. IALE- North American Regional Association of the International Association for Landscape Ecology annual conference. Poster Presentation.

2020. Doucet, A.M. Monarch utilization of experimental milkweed plantings in the Chicago region. University of Illinois at Chicago CIM²AS Internship Symposium, Chicago, IL

2014. Doucet, A.M., Lopez, V., Ruggiero, D., & Garces, A. Difference in rating scores based on race and socioeconomic status. Northeastern Illinois University Fall Student Research and Creative Activities Symposium, Chicago, IL

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

2026-	Chicago Center for Teaching and Learning College Teaching Certificate, University of Chicago, IL
2026-	Certificate in Science Communication, University of Chicago, IL
2025-	Biological Sciences Division Becoming a Leader Program, Warner-Reynolds Endowment for Advancing Leadership in the BSD, University of Chicago, IL
2025	The Lepidoptera Course, Southwestern Research Station, Portal, AZ
2025	Moth-A-Palooza, Ohio

MENTORING

2025	Dex Phillip, Summer Intern, Field Museum of Natural History, Chicago, IL
2022	Madison Dieffenbach, REU Program, Chicago Botanic Garden, Glencoe, IL
2014	Research & science writing tutor, Northeastern Illinois University, Chicago, IL

AWARDS & DISTINCTIONS

2025	Committee on Evolutionary Biology Pritzker Lab Research Award, \$2400
2025	Thomas Park Population Ecology Award, \$1500
2023	Plant Biology and Conservation Travel Award, \$600
2023	Northwestern University Plant Biology and Conservation MS Award, \$1650
2022	Plant Biology and Conservation Travel Award, \$500
2021	Oakton Community College President's Scholar

2020	CIM ² AS summer intern program, \$5,000
2015	Chi Sigma Iota Honor Society Membership
2015	Northeastern Illinois University Arts and Sciences Merit Tuition Scholarship, \$861
2014	Student Excellence Award- Northeastern Illinois University Research Symposium
2014	Alpha Chi National College Honor Society Membership, Illinois Zeta Chapter

PROFESSIONAL SOCIETY MEMBERSHIPS

2025-	Sigma Xi, The Scientific Research Honor Society, Full Member
2025-	Lepidopterists Society
2024-	Entomological Society of America
2024-	American Alliance of Museums
2021-	Ecological Society of America

SCIENCE OUTREACH

2025	Webs, Wings, & Wonderbugs, Museum of Science and Industry, Chicago, IL
2025	Lincoln Park Zoo Intern Pollinator Workshop, Field Museum, Chicago, IL
2025	Chicago Green Ambassadors Pollinator Workshop, Field Museum, Chicago, IL
2025	Arc'Teryx Pollinator Event, Field Museum, Chicago, IL
2024	Bug-A-Palooza, Peggy Notebaert Nature Museum, Chicago, IL
2024	Meet-A-Scientist – Cicadas, Field Museum, Chicago, IL
2023	Pollinator Week BioBlitz, Field Museum, Chicago, IL

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE & VOLUNTEER

2026	Graduate Recruitment Initiative Team, PhD Admissions Practice Interviews, University of Chicago, IL
2025-	Biological Sciences Alumni Council Student Representative, University of Chicago, Chicago, IL
2025	South Side Science Festival, University of Chicago, Chicago, IL
2025	PhD Admissions Interview Week Student Host, University of Chicago, IL
2023	Undergraduate Research Symposium Judge, University of Illinois at Chicago
2021	Great Lakes Alliance Beach Cleanup, Evanston, IL
2018	Forest Preserve Habitat Restoration, District of Cook County, IL
2018	School District 214 College Fair, Arlington Heights, IL
2018	Lake County Haven Women's Shelter, Libertyville, IL
2011-2013	Save-A-Pet Animal Shelter, Grayslake, IL

NON-ACADEMIC WORK EXPERIENCE

2017-2018	Counselor, Buffalo Grove High School, Buffalo Grove, IL
2015-2016	Counselor, Trilogy Behavioral Healthcare, Chicago, IL
2008-2015	Retail, Walgreens, Island Lake, IL